to the HQ, not as a complaint, but to streamline the standard operating procedures (SOP).

Chakrata was a very small cantonment and the station had only very rudimentary facilities. The AQ had a nice house atop a small hillock, not far from the Commandant's Flag Staff House. As far as the Army was concerned, it was a 'field' posting but families could join and stay. There was a small school, run by the Est, which used to operate from an old church building that had been re-appropriated for this purpose. It all seemed reasonably fine and we decided that Veena and the kids should shift to Chakrata, so that we could all be together. The summer holidays were just around the corner, so we decided that Veena should first come up, have a look and take a final decision thereafter, but we had more or less made up our minds. Veena had tendered her resignation at the school and taken the school leaving certificates for the girls since we would all be moving to Chakrata. The three of them came up for the summer holidays and we had a wonderful time. Chakrata in the summers was like heaven. Being a restricted area, there was little or no tourist traffic, unlike nearby Mussoorie. The hills were full of pine trees and rhododendron bushes, out of which the locals made a syrup that could be used to make a refreshing squash. Everything seemed perfect, but unfortunately, it wasn't.

The Commandant and The Deputy Commandant were not getting along. The working environment in the HQ was bordering on the toxic. With contradictory orders emanating from the commandant and the deputy commandant, we as the staff were being pulled in two different directions. Any difference of opinion on professional matters was seen as dissent and penalized. The Commandant wanted to get things done in a hurry, probably to justify his appointment as the first non-Para officer to hold this billet. Whatever may have been the case, he

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